



**Standing tall:** The Prime Minister of India, Mr. Jawaharlal Nehru, hands over a silver plate to Chandu Borde, who had the distinction of scoring the only Test century against the West Indies, before commencement of play on the third day of the fifth Test match at the then Feroze Shah Kotla Stadium in New Delhi on February 8, 1959.

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the best. If I had been selected as a captain but failed to give my best or win the series, I would not have played again. I took it in a positive way. So, I am quite happy now.

Despite going through such experiences and playing purely for passion with very little financial rewards, how do you not sound bitter when you see modern-day

**cricketers earning crores of rupees?**

Not at all. In fact, I enjoy it. Yes, we never played for money. You will be surprised to know that during our time in the 1960s, we were getting ₹250 per match. Damodar Karmarkar (popularly known as Mama Karmakar) was the BCCI secretary then, and he told us: "In the evening, we are going to one gentleman's place for dinner who is financially

well off, and you will be rewarded with ₹1,000 each." We were pleased; we went there, enjoyed a sumptuous vegetarian meal, and that's it. Those thousand rupees are still to come. We were hurt, but then we also forgot. This has happened during my cricket career. But it's good for life too; when you only get success, you get used to it and ignore the lows. Instead, when you experience all of it, success becomes a great feeling. This is what I am enjoying.



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